



A portable NAS device

by creating systems designed specifically for data storage. Instead of starting with a general-purpose computer and configuring or removing features from that base, NAS designs begin with the bare-bones components necessary to support file transfers and add features “from the bottom up.”

But wait – here comes the best part ! You don’t have to go out and purchase a NAS device. You can build a superior alternative using spare parts left over after upgrading your PC. That’s right folks! You can build your very own NAS with the following parts:

- FreeNAS (Free, www.freenas.com)
- ISO recorder (Free, <http://isorecorder.alexfeinman.com/isorecorder.htm>)
- USB thumb drive
- Motherboard
- CPU
- Case
- Memory
- Videocard
- Optical drive
- Power supply
- One or more hard drives

Now that you’ve got hold of all the requisite parts, the first step in the process is to build the physical NAS box. However, since this is no different from assembling a PC, we’ll skip ahead to the installation of the operating system. We’re going to walk you through the finer points of setting up a FreeNAS-based network storage device on your very own.

Burn the FreeNAS ISO to CD

First of all make sure your motherboard’s BIOS is configured to boot from a USB device, as we’ll be installing the operating system to a thumb drive.